







and even the presentation—that allows continuous refinement of their experience.

Bose explains that alcohol in Bengaluru is expensive, restricting the sort of alcohol that bars use. These formats allow him to show more, show better. Also, in such small spaces, occupied by just 4-8 guests allows them to creates a community of like-minded people. "Its something out of the ordinary. People under-stand what they are going to get out of it, and are willing to wait. Once they get in, you have to make sure the experience is that good", he adds.

WHAT ARE GUEST RETURNING FOR

"People don't come to indulge in those 4-5 drinks, that's a lot to have in 90 minutes. People are coming for casual luxury, hence they're ready to pay incrementally. They enjoy the experience, and a chat with our bartenders", Bose explains. To this, Chowdhury adds, " when guests feel seen, engaged and involved, they're far more likely to connect with the experience and this creates a long-lasting impression". And rightly so. These spaces are living up to the added curiosity, wait, and excitement, upping the experience of being at a drinking her-mitage. And this is adding a new definition of luxury to their experiences and its patrons. Rawat says, "Luxury today is defined by time and its quality. When a guest feels recognised rather than processed, that's luxury". Shepra concurs: "The luxury we offer here is solitude and focused attention."

Bose shares another aspect of these bars. "In large bars, with a running menu, bartenders can get bored and restricted. We wanted them to spread their wings. These spaces allow them to experiment, innovate, and stay on top of the game as well. It's a great way for them to earn their own social currency too, tell their stories. That's why in times where there's an over-do of bar take-over, we even do personalised ones where you can come talk to these visiting bartender"

Whether these bars are servicing niche curiosity, or kindling the next chapter in India's cocktail culture, only time can tell. But, one things is for sure, they won't take over the traditional large-format bars. Yet, for a pocket of guests who value intimacy, relaxed, experiential indulgence, these small format, time-reserved spaces will become their next playground.